

Photographers Rejoice!

Transcend, famed for its high-performance storage devices, has introduced the Photobank 20 GB Portable Photo Storage drive. This device is a portable, palm-sized hard drive and a multi-card reader for fast and easy photo/file transfer and storage on the go.

It integrates a 20 GB 1.8" hard drive and a memory card reader compatible with different formats including CF Type I and II, MicroDrive, SM, SD, miniSD (with SD adapter), MMC, RS-MMC (with MMC adapter), MS, MS Pro, MS Duo (with MS adapter), MS PRO Duo (with MS adapter).

It features a B&W, blue backlit LCD that indicates the basic functions of copying, deleting, formatting and displaying information. It connects to a PC, laptop or Mac via the USB 2.0 cable provided, allowing speeds as high as 480 Mbps. The rechargeable Li-Ion battery lasts for nearly three hours on a full charge, but takes four hours to fully charge!

The Transcend Photobank is a blessing that allows professional photographers to backup their memory cards. Business people can use it as a portable hard drive to transfer data between their home PC and laptop. When con-



nected to a computer, it shows up as a removable hard drive with various memory card slots. It supports the FAT12/16/32 file systems.

On the visual appeal front, the Photobank doesn't really score. The buttons feel tacky, are sometimes unresponsive, and generally not very comfortable. It posted a drive index of 16 MB/s in the SiSoft Sandra 2005 SR1 benchmark. In the data transfer test, 1 GB of assorted files could be copied from the Photobank in 57 seconds, while copying the same files to the Photobank took 119 seconds. But at 285 gm, it is very light and can be easily carried around in the protective leather pouch provided.

Unlike its more costly sibling with the TFT LCD and MP3 playback, the Photobank 20 GB is a no-frills but useful device. At Rs 18,000, it's somewhat expensive... but if you are a photographer, you will find the price is justified.

Company **Mediaman Infotech Pvt Ltd**
Price **Rs 18,000**
Phone **022-23828100**
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Web site **www.transcendusa.com**

Rating 

Antec Super LANBOY

Calling All Gamers

Antec, one of the premier brands in PC cases and power supplies, has launched a new case aimed at gamers christened Super LANBOY, the successor of the older LANBOY case. The Super LANBOY sports an anodised aluminium finish and looks classy—similar to the new Apple G5 machines.

The front bezel has a swivel door that covers the optical drive bays. Right below are two USB ports and jacks for sound. A blue LED-lit 120 mm fan covered with a smoky plastic rail adds a bit of touch to the otherwise bland front. Antec has made good use of the unused space near the floppy drive bays by integrating a small toolbox that holds a foldable screwdriver, among other things.

Inside, there are four hard drives, three optical drives and two floppy drive sized devices. The hard disk bays are aligned facing the side panels, making installation easy. Also, the drives have to be mounted on a drive rail. On the rear, is a noiseless, but efficient 120 mm fan.

The side panels have a cutaway acrylic window. Antec has optional accessories such as a sound sensitive blue LED panel (Rs 1,450).

Further, an ultraviolet light (Rs1,550) can brighten up the surroundings.

The Super LANBOY, though, comes at a super price of Rs 5,500—just the price of the cabinet. The power supply and accessories have to be bought separately.



Company **Cyber Space Abacus Pvt Ltd**
Price **Rs 5,500**
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Rating 

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Arihant Flexi Keypad

Ergonomics and the tactile feel of a keyboard are the two most important factors that differentiate the good from the bad.

The Arihant Flexi keyboard appears cool—it can twist, turn, fold, and can also be washed! It's flat and can give you a feeling of typing on the table. This will make it difficult to use, initially. The difficulty will increase when two or three keys will be used in combination, say, [Ctrl+G] or [Alt+F]. The absence of a slope puts more pressure on the palm and fingers—especially the index finger.

Although its rubber surface offers a good grip, it's not soothing for your fingertips. Two major improvements are needed—combining the two separate spacebar buttons and enlarging the backspace button.

Indicator lights for 'Num Scroll' and 'Caps Lock' are arranged at the extreme right under a big black box that looks more like a design anomaly. Available in black, with no hot keys, the keyboard is great for touch typists. The absence of audible feedback and slope are the main hindrances for new users, but those disappear once you get used to it.



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Rating 